Specification of the controlled designation of origin "Crémant d'Alsace"

approved by decree no. 2011-1373 of 25 October 2011, amended by order of 10 November 2016 published in the JORF of 25 November 2016, amended by order of 16 July 2021 published in the JORF of 23 July 2021, amended by order of 21 August 2023 published in the JORF of 24 August 2023, amended by order of 18 November 2024 published in the JORF of 20 November 2024, amended by order of 26 May 2025 published in the JORF of 31 May 2025

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin "Crémant d'Alsace", initially recognised by the decree of 24 August 1976.

This specification is drawn up in accordance with the provisions of ordinance no. 45-2675 of 2 November 1945.

II. – Types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Crémant d'Alsace" is reserved for white or rosé sparkling wines.

III. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The geographical area is as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 31 May 2001 and 8 June 2016. The perimeter of this area, on the date of approval of the present specification by the competent national committee, encompasses the territory of the following communes on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2025. The cartographic documents representing the geographical area may be consulted on the INAO website.

a) – The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration, the ageing and the packaging of the wines are carried out within the territory of the following communes:

- Haut-Rhin department: Ammerschwihr, Beblenheim, Bennwihr, Bergheim, Bergholtz, Bergholtz-Zell, Berrwiller, Buhl, Cernay, Colmar, Eguisheim, Gueberschwihr, Guebwiller, Hartmannswiller, Hattstatt, Herrlisheim-près-Colmar, Houssen, Hunawihr, Husseren-les-Châteaux, Ingersheim, Jungholtz, Katzenthal, Kaysersberg Vignoble, Leimbach, Mittelwihr, Niedermorschwihr, Obermorschwihr, Orschwihr, Osenbach, Pfaffenheim, Ribeauvillé, Riquewihr, Rorschwihr, Rodern, Rouffach, Saint-Hippolyte, Soultz-Haut-Rhin, Soultzmatt, Steinbach, Thann, Turckheim, Uffholtz, Vieux-Thann, Voegtlinshoffen, Walbach, Wattwiller, Westhalten, Wettolsheim, Wihr-au-Val, Wintzenheim, Wuenheim, Zellenberg, Zimmerbach.

- Bas-Rhin department: Albé, Andlau, Avolsheim, Balbronn, Barr, Bergbieten, Bernardswiller, Bernardvillé, Bischoffsheim, Blienschwiller, Boersch, Bourgheim, Châtenois, Cleebourg, Dahlenheim, Dambach-la-Ville, Dangolsheim, Dieffenthal, Dorlisheim, Eichhoffen, Epfig, Ergersheim, Flexbourg, Furdenheim, Gertwiller, Gimbrett (associated commune, attached to Berstett), Goxwiller, Heiligenstein, Itterswiller, Kienheim, Kintzheim, Kirchheim, Kuttolsheim, Marlenheim, Mittelbergheim, Molsheim, Mutzig, Nothalten, Nordheim, Oberhoffen-lès-Wissembourg, Obernai, Odratzheim, Orschwiller, Osthoffen, Ottrott, Reichsfeld, Riedseltz, Rosenwiller, Rosheim, Rott, Saint-Nabor, Saint-Pierre, Scharrachbergheim-Irmstett, Scherwiller, Soultz-les-Bains, Steinseltz, Stotzheim, Traenheim, Villé, Wangen, Westhoffen, Wissembourg, Wolxheim, Zellwiller.

b) – The vinification, the elaboration, the ageing and the packaging of the wines may also be carried out within the territory of the following communes:

Haut-Rhin department: Gundolsheim, Ostheim, Wolfgantzen.

Bas-Rhin department: Dachstein, Ernolsheim-Bruche, Fessenheim-le-Bas, Petersbach, Seebach, Sélestat, Strasbourg.

Commune included in part: Wingersheim les Quatre Bans (for the territory of the delegated commune of Mittelhausen only).

2° – Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 9 and 10 November 1988, 4 and 5 November 1998, 10 and 11 February 1999, 27 and 28 May 1999, 27 and 28 May 2004, 9 March 2005, 9 and 10 November 2005, 13 March 2008, 10 February 2011, 11 September 2014, 30 November 2022 and 25 June 2024.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

IV. – Grape varieties

1° – Grape varieties

a) – The white wines come from the following varieties: auxerrois B, chardonnay B, pinot blanc B, pinot gris G, pinot noir N, riesling B.

Varieties of interest for adaptation purposes, subject to the signature between the INAO, the ODG and the authorised operators concerned of an agreement conforming to the framework agreement approved by the competent national committee: voltis B, opalor B, selenor B, souvignier gris G, johanniter B, chenin B, vermentino B.

b) – The rosé wines come from the pinot noir variety.

Varieties of interest for adaptation purposes, subject to the signature between the INAO, the ODG and the authorised operators concerned of an agreement conforming to the framework agreement approved by the competent national committee: coliris N, nebbiolo N, syrah N.

c) – The communal planting plan approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality will be lodged at the town hall of the communes concerned.

2° – Proportion rules on the holding

a) – White wines: the proportion of the varieties of interest for adaptation purposes is less than or equal to 5 % of the planting of the holding.

b) – Rosé wines: the proportion of the varieties of interest for adaptation purposes is less than or equal to 5 % of the planting of the holding.

V. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density

The vines have a minimum planting density of 4,000 plants per hectare. They may not have a spacing between rows greater than 2.50 metres. The vines have a spacing within the row of between 0.75 metre minimum and 1.50 metres maximum.

From 25 October 2011, the grubbing-up of rows within a parcel may not result in a spacing between the widest rows greater than 3 metres.

b) – Pruning rules

The vines are pruned by single or double Guyot pruning with a maximum of 24 free eyes per plant.

c) – Trellising and foliage height rules

The foliage is trained on a vertical trellis. The height of trellised foliage may not be less than 0.675 times the spacing between rows. This height is measured between the attachment wire and the upper limit of the foliage after trimming. The distance between the carrying wire and the attachment wire may not exceed 0.40 metre.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel

The average maximum load per parcel is set at 16,000 kilograms per hectare.

Where irrigation is authorised, in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, the average maximum load per parcel of irrigated parcels is set at 12,000 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Threshold of missing vines

The percentage of dead or missing vine plants referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine

The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

a) – In order to preserve the characteristics of the soils, which constitute a fundamental element of the terroir:

Headlands wider than one metre are grassed, with the exception of vines that cannot be mechanised, known locally as “Kammerle”.

Partial or total covering of the soil and of the vines with sheeting is prohibited. However, for evaluation purposes, covering of the soil with sheeting is authorised under the following conditions. The material must be permeable, allow gas and water exchanges, and its composition must not include petrochemical polymers. The evaluation is carried out subject to the signature of an agreement between the INAO, the ODG and the authorised operator concerned, conforming to the framework agreement approved by the competent national committee of 29 and 30 June 2023. In this context, the area of the parcels subject to the evaluation is limited to 5 % of the total area of the holding declared under the AOC.

b) – Vine plantings and replantings are carried out with plant material all of whose components are produced in protected zones or have undergone hot-water treatment as defined by the order in force relating to the control of flavescence dorée.

3° – Irrigation

a) Irrigation may be authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

b) Overhead sprinkling of the foliage is prohibited.

c) The application of fertiliser (fertigation) is prohibited.

VI. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at good ripeness. The date of the start of the harvest is set in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-6 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code and of Article 2 of ordinance no. 45-2675 of 2 November 1945 on the definition of the designations of origin of the wines of Alsace.

b) – Particular harvesting provisions

The wines come from grapes harvested by hand.

c) – Particular provisions for transport of the harvest

The grapes are transported in containers with a capacity not exceeding 0.60 m³. Traditional Alsace "bottiches" may be used for transporting the harvest; their filling height is at most 0.75 m. For any other type of container, this height does not exceed 0.45 m.

Harvest transport containers are sheltered from bad weather.

The time elapsing between picking the grapes and pressing must be as short as possible. In no case may this time exceed 24 hours.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – Sugar content of the grapes

Grapes with a sugar content of less than 144 grams of sugar per litre of must may not be considered to be at good ripeness.

b) – Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume

The wines have a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of 9 %.

VII. – Yields – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 80 hectolitres per hectare.

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 96 hectolitres per hectare.

3° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may only be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the second year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the first year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the first year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the planting of each parcel concerned.

4° – Particular provisions

The base wines intended for the elaboration of wines liable to benefit from the controlled designation of origin are obtained within the limit of 100 litres of must per 150 kilograms of grapes used.

The rate of rebêches referred to in Article D. 645-16 of the Rural Code is a minimum extraction of between 1 % and 10 % of the quantity of settled musts eligible for the controlled designation of origin.

VIII. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Reception and pressing

The grapes intended for the elaboration of white wines are poured whole into the press.

The pressing installations comply with the provisions below. The opening, extension or modification of a pressing installation requires authorisation before the installation enters into operation.

Criteria linked to the reception of the harvest	**Rules to be complied with**
Reception of the harvest	Harvest reception installation sheltered from bad weather.
Draining and crushing	The use of any draining and crushing system involving a helical screw is prohibited.
Criteria linked to the press	**Rules to be complied with**
Siting of the press(es)	– Press sheltered from bad weather while in operation. – Pressing installation sheltered from bad weather.
Type	The use of any harvest pressing system involving a helical screw, or of presses containing chains, is prohibited.
Criteria linked to loading	**Rules to be complied with**
Weighing device	Compulsory and adapted to the type of containers used for the harvest.
Storage area	Containers holding harvest sheltered from bad weather.
Drop height of the grapes	– Direct gravity feeding of the press is preferred for the installation of any new pressing site built after 20 February 2002. Where the situation does not allow adaptation for direct gravity feeding of the presses, the initial drop is made directly onto the conveying system. – The initial drop height does not exceed 1 metre in free fall. If necessary, it may be supplemented by an accompanied drop of 1 metre maximum.

Criteria linked to the reception of the harvest	**Rules to be complied with**
Conveying of the grapes and grape belts	– Where the grapes are conveyed to the press by means of a mobile hopper, the maximum unit load allowed for it is 1,000 kilograms of grapes. Hoppers may only be used for immediate transfer to the press and may in no case be used for intermediate storage. Hoppers feed the presses directly, excluding any other intermediate conveying system. – Where the grapes drop from one belt onto another, the maximum height allowed is 0.80 metre. The drop is accompanied to avoid any detachment of berries. – For any reception and pressing site set up from the date of approval of the present specification, or for any site in place on that same date that undergoes a major modification of the structure or of the constituent elements of the site, a maximum of 2 belts between the first drop and the press is authorised. – Where 2 grape conveyor belts follow one another, the second has a speed less than or equal to the first. The second belt has a width greater than or equal to the first. – The maximum inclination authorised for a grape conveyor belt is 45°. – Where the conveying system includes a slope down which the grapes slide, the maximum inclination of this slope is 45°. – Any “anti-jamming” system or device that impairs the integrity of the grapes must be removed.
Criteria linked to fractionation	**Rules to be complied with**
Self-pressing	The self-pressing juices resulting from the harvest conveying system are separated. These self-pressing juices may not be taken into account in calculating the volume of rebêches.
Criteria linked to hygiene	**Rules to be complied with**
Storage and pressing area	The floor of the reception and pressing premises can be easily cleaned (nature of the floor, water point, drainage…).
Press	Daily washing of the press is compulsory.
Harvest containers	Washing of the harvest containers after each emptying is compulsory.

b) – Blending of varieties

- For white wines, the proportion of the varieties of interest for adaptation purposes is less than or equal to 10 % of the blend.

- For rosé wines, the proportion of the varieties of interest for adaptation purposes is less than or equal to 10 % of the blend.

c) – Analytical standards

After disgorging, the wines have a carbon dioxide overpressure at least equal to 4 atmospheres measured at a temperature of 20 °C.

After disgorging, the wines have a total sulphur dioxide content less than or equal to 150 milligrams per litre.

d) – Oenological practices and physical treatments

The use of pieces of wood is prohibited.

After prise de mousse, before disgorging and after enrichment, the wines do not exceed a total alcoholic strength by volume of 13 %.

e) – Vinification vat capacity

Every operator has a vinification vat capacity equivalent to 1.2 times the volume of the previous harvest.

f) – Upkeep of the cellar and equipment

The cellar (floors and walls) and the vinification equipment are in a good general state of upkeep.

2° – Provisions by type of product

a) – The base wines intended for the elaboration of rosé wines may come from maceration or saignée.

b) – The wines are elaborated exclusively by second fermentation in glass bottles.

c) – Bottling (tirage) in the bottles in which the prise de mousse takes place may only take place from 1 December following the harvest.

d) – The period of storage in bottle on lees may not be less than 9 months.

3° – Provisions relating to packaging

a) – For every packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body:

- the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code;

- an analysis carried out before or after packaging.

The analysis reports are kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

b) – The wines are elaborated and sold in the bottles inside which the prise de mousse took place, with the exception of wines sold in bottles with a volume of less than 37.5 centilitres or more than 150 centilitres.

4° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator provides evidence of an appropriate, closed and covered place for the storage of packaged products.

5° – Provisions relating to the circulation of products and placing on the market for the consumer

a) – Date of placing on the market for the consumer

The wines may only be placed on the market for the consumer after an ageing period of at least 12 months from the date of tirage.

Where a “remise en cercle” (return of bottled lots to bulk) is carried out by an operator, the minimum ageing period is determined from the date of the new tirage in bottle.

b) – Period during which the wines may not circulate between authorised warehousekeepers

Base wines may circulate between authorised warehousekeepers at the earliest on 1 December of the year of harvest.

After tirage in bottle, the products may only circulate between authorised warehousekeepers after a period of at least 9 months from the date of tirage.

IX. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The geographical area is situated in a northern zone and is established mainly on the east-facing side of the Vosges foothills. Stretching 120 km in length, often for less than 1 km in width, the vineyard extends from a small enclave around Cleebourg in the north, then from Marlenheim level with Strasbourg, down to Thann level with Mulhouse in the south.

The Alsace vineyard is set on a succession of sub-Vosgian hills, interspersed with deep, varied valleys with an often marked relief. The altitude of the plantings lies mostly between 200 m and 400 m.

The climate is clearly semi-continental: temperature differences are large. Winters are cold (the average temperature in January is 1.9 °C) and summers hot and dry (the average temperature in July is above 20 °C). The sum of effective temperatures (above 10 °C) during the vine's growing period (1 April – 30 September) reaches 1,253 °C. The grape ripening period is characterised by an alternation of hot days and cool nights.

The Vosges massif acts as a protective screen against oceanic influences, a role amplified by a föhn effect, especially in autumn. This screen favours:

- high sunshine (1,800 h/year in Colmar);

- low rainfall: the summits of the Vosges receive annual precipitation of the order of 2,000 mm, whereas over the vineyard as a whole precipitation lies between 500 mm and 650 mm;

- excellent autumn conditions.

The subsidence of the north–south Rhine Graben created an extensive network of geological faults forming a mosaic of small compartments presenting very varied geo-pedological situations. The vineyard lies in the fracture zone between the sedimentary Rhine plain and the crystalline Vosges massif, where all the layers of ground that had accumulated during the various geological periods have been laid bare by erosion, thus offering very varied geo-pedological situations:

- brown soils on schist, granite or sandstone (Vosges substrate), shallow, free-draining and tending to acidity;

- colluvial soils of alluvial fans, and alluvial soils, sandy-gravelly, little developed, free-draining and tending to acidity (edge of the alluvial plain);

- calcareous brown soils or rendzina-type soils of the sub-Vosgian hills, as well as interbedded conglomerates and marls, with a good water regime.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

When Alsace was under the German Empire, several Champagne houses brought their know-how in elaboration by second fermentation in bottle. Building on this transfer, and having discovered the technique precisely at the 1900 World Fair in Paris, Julien DOPFF wished to experiment with this production technique using base wines produced in Alsace.

Subsequently, this first initiative was enriched by the contribution of other renowned houses of the Alsace vineyard, which developed the production of local sparkling wines. From then on, numerous trials were undertaken on the various varieties grown in the region in order to determine the most suitable for this new production. They made it possible, initially, to orient the choice towards the pinot family. They finally made it possible to define the list of authorised varieties, namely: auxerrois B, chardonnay B, pinot blanc B, pinot gris G, pinot noir N and riesling B.

On 7 November 1974, these different forces came together within a producers' syndicate. This syndicate contributed to the work undertaken at national and European level on the definition of the production method enshrined under the indication "Crémant". This contribution, together with mastery of the production technique, led to the recognition of the controlled designation of origin "Crémant d'Alsace" by the decree of 24 August 1976.

Training the foliage on high trellises is preferred.

The harvest is carried out at optimal ripeness, by hand, and transported to the pressing installations in containers that must not hold more than 100 kilograms of grapes, in order to preserve the integrity of the grapes.

The grapes intended for the elaboration of white wines must be poured whole into the press. The pressing installations (reception, press, loading of the press, hygiene) are subject to rigorously defined and checked rules. In 2009, some 500 installations were authorised, representing more than half of the region's viticultural installations.

The wines come from pressing governed by a strict extraction rate, to which a rate of rebêches is compulsorily added.

The wines may only be placed on the market for the consumer after an ageing period of at least 12 months from the date of tirage.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

The white and rosé wines (the latter made from the single variety pinot noir N) are built on a structure that is both complex and naturally acid-dominated, which gives the wine all its freshness and finesse. This acidity is accompanied by fruity notes. During ageing on lees, riper aromatic notes appear, often accompanied by buttery or toasted-bread notes. The mousse is fine and light.

The white wines have a colour ranging, most often, from pale yellow with green highlights to golden yellow. The rosé wines most often have a transparent pink colour of variable intensity.

The great majority of the wines are placed on the market for the consumer in the "brut" category.

3° – Causal interactions

The climatic situation of the vineyard, characterised by the alternation of hot days and cool nights throughout the grape ripening period, combined with a high foliage height, ensures good ripeness of the grapes (sugars and tartaric acidity). The average altitude of the vineyard (200 m to 400 m), which corresponds to the optimal thermal belt, makes it possible to ensure a qualitative balance of the natural acidity.

The low rainfall at the end of summer and the temperature range between day and night during ripening make it possible to maintain a very good sanitary condition of the grapes, essential to the quality of the pressing and conducive to the elaboration of a fine mousse.

Harvests carried out at optimal ripeness ensure an excellent sugar–acidity balance, necessary for guaranteed freshness, good prise de mousse and good ageing potential.

The diversity of viticultural situations, with very varied geo-pedological conditions, has offered producers the possibility of finding, for each of the six varieties that have become established, its conditions of optimal expression, favouring freshness and acidity combined with fruity characters.

Drawing on the experience acquired with the separate vinification of the varieties, the producers manage their blends, whose composition stems from perfectly mastered know-how according to the varieties and the vintage, so as to ensure a certain constancy in the acid balance of the wines.

The preservation of the integrity of the grapes from harvest onwards, and the pressing rules laid down by the specification, guarantee the clarity of the juices, essential to the quality of the prise de mousse. Ageing on lees, often much longer than nine months, reinforces the complexity of the wines by developing tertiary aromas.

From the 1980s, "Crémant d'Alsace" was regarded by Alsace consumers as the festive wine and served at official celebrations. Growing steadily every year, production represents 25 % of the

controlled designations of origin produced in Alsace.

The prestigious national "Crémants" competition each year particularly distinguishes the quality of wines of the controlled designation of origin "Crémant d'Alsace". In the "Effervescents du Monde" competitions, "Crémant d'Alsace" regularly ranks among the top places.

Sales of the wines outside the national territory, initially concentrated on Germany, are diversifying across all the countries of northern Europe and reach 20 %.

X. – Transitional measures

1° – Training method

The planting density and the trellising and pruning rules do not apply to vines planted before 25 October 2011. These vines continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the designation "Crémant d'Alsace" until they are grubbed up. However, these vines:

- comply with the rules relating to the distance between the carrying wire and the attachment wire;

- comply with the rules relating to the maximum number of free eyes per plant;

- when pruned by the Guyot method, must be pruned by single Guyot or double Guyot pruning.

From the 2034 harvest, and for the parcels concerned, the volume that may benefit from the right to the controlled designation of origin is established on the basis of the yield set in point 1 of chapter VII of the present specification, multiplied by a coefficient of 0.8.

2° – Grape varieties

The communal planting plan approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality applies only to new plantings, replantings or top-graftings carried out from the date on which the said plan is lodged at the town hall of the commune concerned.

3° – Reception and pressing

Conveying of the grapes and grape belts: for any reception and pressing site installation carried out before 25 October 2011, and provided that this installation does not undergo a major modification of the structure or of the constituent elements of the site, a maximum of 4 belts between the first drop and the press is authorised.

XI. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin "Crémant d'Alsace" is claimed and which are presented under this appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and movement documents, and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

a) The name of the controlled designation of origin is entered on the cork, on the part contained in the neck of the bottle.

b) The varieties of interest for adaptation purposes may not be mentioned on the labelling.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Prior declaration of parcel assignment

Every operator declares to the defence and management body the list of parcels assigned to the production of the controlled designation of origin before 15 May preceding the harvest.

This declaration is renewable by tacit renewal, unless changes are notified by the operator before 15 May preceding each harvest.

This declaration specifies:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the cooperative cellar(s) to which the operator may deliver;

- for each parcel: the cadastral reference, the area and the grape variety.

The operator may declare to the defence and management body that they renounce producing the controlled designation of origin at the latest on 15 August preceding the harvest.

2. Declaration of intention to produce

In the absence of a prior declaration of parcel assignment, the operator lodges with the defence and management body a declaration of intention to produce at least 8 days before the harvest. This declaration specifies in particular, for the parcel(s) concerned:

- the cadastral reference;

- the area;

- the grape varieties.

The prior declaration of parcel assignment serves as the declaration of intention to produce.

3. Irrigation declaration

An irrigation declaration is sent to the defence and management body and to the control body at the latest 2 days before irrigation, in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code. This declaration is drawn up according to the model defined by the defence and management body.

4. Declaration relating to vinification vat capacity

Every operator vinifying wines of the controlled designation of origin sends the defence and management body, at the latest on 31 August of the year of harvest, a declaration relating to vinification vat capacity. The cellar plan annexed to the identification declaration may serve as the declaration relating to vinification vat capacity. This declaration is renewable by tacit renewal, unless changes are notified by the operator before 31 August of the year of harvest. In the event of a sale of grapes, this declaration specifies the destination of the harvest, in particular on the basis of the inter-trade contract entered into.

5. Claim declaration for base wines

A claim declaration for base wines is sent to the defence and management body before 15 February of the year following that of the harvest.

It indicates:

- the designation claimed;

- the volume of base wine;

- the grape variety;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the name and address of the applicant;

- the place of storage of the base wine.

It is accompanied by:

- a copy of the harvest declaration and an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes, musts or base wines;

- a copy of the press register.

6. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body within a maximum period of 60 days following the end of tirage.

It indicates:

- the designation claimed;

- the colour;

- the volume of the wine, expressed as a number of bottles;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the name and address of the applicant;

- the place of storage of the wine.

It is accompanied by an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes, musts or base wines and by the general plan of the storage places.

7. Prior declaration of collections (base wines)

Every operator wishing to move base wines sends the approved control body a transaction declaration for the lot concerned between the day the transaction is contracted and at least eight days before collection. If the volume actually collected differs by more or less than 10 % from the volume indicated when the contract was concluded, the operator makes a correction available to the approved control body.

8. Declaration of "remise en cercle"

Any remise en cercle is the subject of a prior declaration to the approved control body at least 48 hours before the start of operations. This prior declaration indicates in particular the nature, the volume and, where applicable, the vintage of the products used.

9. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must declare it to the defence and management body and to the approved control body within a maximum period of 15 days after this downgrading.

II. – Keeping of registers

Keeping a press register is compulsory. It is filled in as the pressing operations proceed. This register specifies, for each press load (marc):

- the date and time of the start of each operation;

- the weight of grapes used, by variety;

- the commune of origin of the grapes;

- the name of the operator;

- the volumes of musts obtained;

- the potential alcoholic strength by volume;

- the volumes of rebêches.

Entries are made in indelible ink.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	Documentary checks or check in the field
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B.1 – Management of the vineyard	
Average maximum load per parcel	Check in the field
B.2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes	
Manual harvesting of the grapes	Check in the field
Period of storage in bottle on lees	Documentary check and on-site check
B.3 – Yields – Entry into production	
Juice yield and rate of rebêches	Documentary check
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Wines after prise de mousse and before disgorging	Analytical and organoleptic examination

II. – References concerning the control structure

Institut National de l'Origine et de la Qualité (INAO)

TSA 30003, 93555 MONTREUIL Cedex

Tel.: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.00 – Email: contact@inao.gouv.fr

Compliance with the present specification is checked on the basis of an approved control plan, by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence that has received delegation from the INAO.